MIL-C-48243C (AR)
AMENDMENT 4
4 August 1983
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 3
17 February 1982

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHARGE, PROPELLING, 155MM, M203
LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This Amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-C-48243C (AR) dated 1 February 1979, and is approved for use by the US Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 1

2.1, Specifications, Military: Add the following new reference:

"MIL-STD-1235 - Single and multilevel continuous sampling procedures and tables for inspection by attributes"

PAGE 2

2.1, Drawings: Delete drawing "9293303" and "PA68" and substitute drawing "9331254" and "PA91".

PAGE 3

3.7, Table 1: - Delete velocity minimum "2685" and maximum "2735" and substitute velocity minimum "2675" and maximum "2745".

Add the following:

"Note: The PXR 6325 projectile simulator may be used as an alternate to the inert loaded M549 RA projectile."

PAGE 4

4.3.1: Delete drawing "9293303" and substitute drawing "9331254".

FSC: 1320

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 9

Table 1 - First Article Inspection: Delete Dwgs "9281897 and 9293303" and substitute Dwgs. "9281897 and 9331254".

PAGE 19

4.4.2.10, Cap: Add to the title: "Cap (Alternate: Tube Closure)"; add to the drawing number: "9289199"; and add to next higher assembly: "9345159".

PAGE 20

4.4.2.11, Complete igniter assembly:

Critical category: Add to critical defect 2, examination or test: "(----of cap "or tube closure")".

Major category: Add to major defect 103, examination or test: "Cap "or tube closure" missing or insecure".

PAGE 30

4.4.2.21, Increment loading assembly:

Major category: Add new major defect 104 as follows:

"104	Increment damaged to the extent that propellant can escape (includes any seams or openings incompletely stitched and broken threads)	100%	3.2	Visual"

PAGE 31

4.4.2.22: Delete entire paragraph.

PAGE 34

4.4.2.24, Charge, propelling, M203 for 155mm Howitzer M198:

Major category: Delete "Major 108" and substitute new major defect 108 as follows:

"108	Any component missing or improperly assembled (including flash reducer)"	100%	3.2	Visual

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Add the following new major defects:

"109	Flash reducer (assembly) damaged to the extent that potassium sulfate can escape"	100%	3.2	Visual
"110	Strap loose, broken or insecurely tied (prior to assembly of lacing jacket to the charge)"	0.40%	3.2	Visual Manual
Proving Ground				
"111	Muzzle velocity and muzzle velocity standard deviation"	15	3.7	4.5.6

PAGE 35

4.4.2.25: Delete Drawing Number "9293303" and substitute Drawing Number "9331254".

PAGE 36

4.4.2.26: Delete Drawing Number "9293303" and substitute Drawing Number "9331254" (two places).

PAGE 38

4.4.2.27: Delete Drawing Number "9293303" and substitute Drawing Number "9331254".

PAGE 42

* 4.5.6: Delete entire paragraph and substitute new paragraph as follows:

"4.5.6 Proving ground (see 3.7). - This test shall be conducted at a government proving ground in accordance with the applicable acceptance test procedure using M549, RA or PXR-6325 projectiles inert loaded within 0.1 pound of an as fired weight of 96.0 pounds using primer, M82 and fired in cannon M199 with 75 percent (minimum) remaining life. Firing shall be conducted with a spindle to charge base stand-off of 1 inch (plus or minus 1/4 inch). Prior to firing, all charges shall be temperature conditioned in a large conditioning box with adequate air circulation at the required temperature for a minimum of 24 hours and assurance will be made that, when fired, the charges are at the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

conditioning temperature. The following tolerances shall apply to all -65°F, 145°F and 70°F conditioning; -65°F from -60°F to -65°F; 145°F from 140°F to 145°F; 70°F from 68°F to 72°F. Copper crusher gages (2) shall be used to measure the maximum chamber pressure of each charge. Temperature indicator (thermometer) strips (see 6.20) shall be placed on the side (lacing jacket) of all charges or on the side of the metal containers, as applicable, conditioned at 145°F as a further assurance of the proper conditioning temperature. If any indicator strip shows the charge has been exposed to a temperature greater than 145°F, that charge will not be fired."

PAGE 44

5. Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

* "5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing

5.1.1 Level A - The propelling charges shall be packed, sealed and tested in accordance with the specified requirements of drawing 9331254.

5.1.2 Level B - Same as level A.

5.1.3 Level C - Same as level A.

5.2 MARKING

5.2.1 Level A - The propelling charges shall be marked in accordance with the specified requirements of drawing 9331254.

5.2.2 Level B - Same as level A.

5.2.3 Level C - Same as level A."

PAGE 46

6.10.1, Method 1: Add to average weight of cap: "or tube closure" and to the drawing number 9289199: "or 9345159".

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 47

6.10.2; Method 2: Add to average weight of cap: "or tube closure" and to the drawing number 9289199: "or 9345159".

PAGE 48

Add a new paragraph:

"6.19 International standardization agreements. Certain provisions (see 3.7 and 6.15) of this specification are the subject of international standardization agreement (Quardilateral MOU concerning the standardization of elements of 155MM Howitzer and ammunition, 28 April 78). When amendment, revision, or cancellation of this specification is proposed which will affect or violate the international agreement concerned, the preparing activity will take appropriate reconciliation action through Project Manager, Cannon Artillery Weapons Systems/Joint Project Manager, Semi-Active Laser Guided Projectiles (PM-CAWS/JPM SAL GP).

Add a new paragraph:

"6.20 Temperature indicator strips. The highest temperature reading from each indicator strip shall be recorded for informational purposes and reported on the applicable firing record." The temperature indicators shall be self-adhesive and may be a single dot or a multiple strip. the minimum temeprature range shall be 148-150°F, with a tolerance of ± 1 percent."

NOTE: The margins of this amendment are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous amendment were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous amendment.

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

(Project 1320-A680)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.